



Jubilation: Gregory Rodrigues savours the moment after a rewarding night against Anthony Hernandez at UFC Sacramento. GETTYIMAGES

Hardwired to win

Gregory Rodrigues **outlasts** Anthony Hernandez in a gruelling five-round battle to claim the biggest win of his UFC career and extend his winning streak to four.

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Gregory Rodrigues produced the biggest win of his UFC career, outlasting hometown favourite Anthony Hernandez in a five-round battle to headline UFC Sacramento at the Golden 1 Center.

Rodrigues earned a unanimous decision victory, with the judges scoring the contest 48-47, 49-46 and 48-47.

The Brazilian used a steady stream of damaging calf kicks to trouble Hernandez early and repeatedly disrupt the American's rhythm.

Hernandez, however, refused to fade and produced his best moments in the middle rounds, turning the fight into a gruelling 25-minute contest.

Rodrigues' takedown defence proved equally crucial. He successfully

neutralised most of Hernandez's wrestling attempts to secure his fourth straight victory. The fight was later awarded Fight of the Night honours.

The co-main event saw Vitor Petrino continue his successful run at heavyweight, dominating Serghei Spivac en route to a unanimous decision victory. All three judges scored the bout 30-27.

Reinier de Ridder also made a statement, stopping Roman Dolidze via first-round TKO, while MarQuel Mederos handed Mason Jones a rare defeat with a second-round stoppage.

Carli Judice impressed with a first-round TKO win over previously unbeaten Jeisla Chaves, and Anthony Wint opened his UFC account with a first-round arm-triangle submission of Terrance Chatman.



Did you know?

In his 2022 fight against Chidi Njokuani, Rodrigues suffered a gruesome gash between his eyebrows after absorbing a knee early in the contest. The cut was so severe that it left his forehead split open, but Rodrigues refused to wilt. Instead, he fought through the damage and stopped Njokuani in the second round. The scar has since become a defining feature of his appearance, adding another layer to the moniker of 'Robocop'.

The prelims featured several finishes, including Shamil Gaziev's quick knockout of Kennedy Nzechukwu (1:20, R1). Chris Padilla also produced a dramatic third-round submission of Nasrat Haqparast with just a second remaining.

But the night belonged to Rodrigues, whose victory over the highly ranked Hernandez could significantly boost his standing in the middleweight division.

Booked out

The UFC has announced the dates and venues for its final two numbered events of 2026, with UFC 334 set for Madison Square Garden in New York on November 14 and UFC 335 scheduled for the T-Mobile Arena in Las Vegas on December 12.

UFC 334 will mark the promotion's 10th event at Madison Square Garden, which has hosted several landmark cards since the UFC's debut there with UFC 205 in 2016. The venue has since staged memorable events featuring stars such as Conor McGregor, Georges St-Pierre, Israel Adesanya and Jon Jones.

The action will then shift to Las Vegas for UFC 335, which will serve as the final numbered pay-per-view card of 2026. No fights have yet been announced for either event, but the confirmation of the dates gives the UFC's year-end schedule a clearer shape.